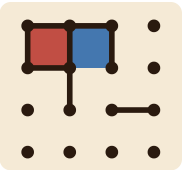
Dots and Boxes: How to Play



Dots and Boxes is for 2 to 4 players. The board is a grid of dots. Take turns drawing one line between two dots that are next to each other, across or down.

Boxes

- When your line closes the fourth side of a box, the box is yours: it fills with your colour, your initials and your symbol.
- **Close a box and you draw again.** One line can close two boxes at once; you still get one extra line.
- If your line closes nothing, the next player in seat order goes.

The end

The game ends when every box has been claimed. Whoever has the most boxes wins. If two or more players share the top count, they tie.

Drawing a line

- **Mouse:** point at a gap between two dots to preview the line, then click.
- **Touch:** tap a gap to preview, then tap it again to draw.
- **Keyboard:** press Tab to move between the open lines (each is named by its two dots, such as "A1 to B1"), then press Enter or Space.

Table option

Grid: Small (9 boxes), Medium (16 boxes, the default) or Large (36 boxes).